

Word family: **question / questions / questioned / questioning / questionable / unquestionably / unquestionable / questionnaire**

Base word: question

Plural: questions

Past tense: questioned

Past participle: questioned

** -ing form:** questioning

Related forms: questionable, unquestionable, unquestionably, questionnaire

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “More importantly, he asks sharp **questions**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **question** means **something someone asks in order to obtain information, hear another person's opinion, or make them think about something**.

Mr. Wong asks questions that are perceptive and thought-provoking.

繁體中文： **為了取得資料、了解別人的想法或引導對方思考，而向別人提出的詢問**

中文翻譯：

> “More importantly, he asks sharp **questions**.”

「更重要的是，他很會問**尖銳而有意思的問題**。」

Here:

ask a question = 為了取得回答、資訊或想法而向別人提出詢問

1. **question = something asked for an answer (詢問) — 問題；疑問**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A sentence or expression used to ask for information, an opinion, an explanation, or an answer.

Practice 1 — Original

> “More importantly, he asks sharp **questions**.”

「更重要的是，他很會問尖銳而有意思的**問題**。」

Practice 2

> “Can I ask you a **question**?”

「我可以問你一個**問題**嗎？」

Practice 3

> “She asked several **questions** about the project.”

「她就這個項目問了幾個**問題**。」

****question = 為了取得回答、資訊、解釋或意見而提出的詢問****

Common:

- * ask a question
- * answer a question
- * difficult question
- * personal question
- * rhetorical question
- * follow-up question

These remain one underlying sense.

2. ****question = test/exam/task item (考試 / 練習) — 題目****

A ****question**** can also be an item in an examination, quiz, worksheet, interview form, etc. that the learner or respondent must answer.

Practice 4

> “I couldn’t answer the final ****question**** on the exam.”

「我答不到考試最後一道****題目****。」

Practice 5

> “Read each ****question**** carefully before choosing an answer.”

「選擇答案之前，仔細閱讀每一道****題目****。」

****question = 考試、測驗或練習中要求作答的一個題目****

Semantically, this develops directly from Meaning 1:

> someone asks something → another person supplies an answer.

So for your ****core database count****, I would ****merge this with #1****, while still showing it because the natural Chinese changes from 「問題」 to 「題目」.

3. ****question = issue/matter to be considered (議題 / 事情) — 問題 ; 議題 ; 事項****

Here, ****question**** does not mean a sentence ending with a question mark.

It means a ****matter or issue that needs to be discussed, considered, or decided****.

Practice 6

> “The ****question**** of funding has not yet been resolved.”

「資金這個****問題 / 議題****仍未解決。」

Practice 7

> “We need to consider the ****question**** of whether the plan is practical.”

「我們需要考慮這項計劃是否實際這個****問題****。」

****the question of something = 需要討論、研究、判斷或作出決定的一個事項或議題****

This is genuinely different from simply asking someone for information.

4. ****question = doubt/uncertainty (懷疑 / 疑問) — 疑問 ; 不確定性****

****Question**** can refer to uncertainty about whether something is true, valid, possible, or acceptable.

Practice 8

> “There is some ****question**** about whether the figures are accurate.”

「這些數字是否準確仍有一些****疑問 / 不確定性****。」

Practice 9

> “His honesty was never in **question**.”

「他的誠信從來沒有受到**懷疑**。」

question = 對某件事情是否真實、正確、可靠或成立所存在的懷疑或不確定

This is an important separate sense.

5. **question** + person (動詞) — 詢問 ; 盤問

As a verb, **question** can mean to ask someone questions, often systematically or formally.

Practice 10

> “Police **questioned** several witnesses.”

「警方**盤問 / 詢問**了幾名證人。」

Practice 11

> “The interviewer **questioned** her about her previous experience.”

「面試官就她過往的經驗向她作出**提問 / 詢問**。」

question someone = 向某人提出一連串問題以取得資料、事實或解釋

The tone depends on context:

* interview → 詢問

* police investigation → 盤問

* ordinary context → 提問

These do not require separate meanings.

6. **question** + claim/decision/authority (動詞) — 質疑 ; 懷疑

This is another major verb meaning.

Meaning: To express doubt about whether something is true, correct, sensible, legitimate, or

justified.

Practice 12

> “Several experts **questioned** the accuracy of the report.”

「幾名專家**質疑**這份報告的準確性。」

Practice 13

> “She began to **question** whether she had made the right decision.”

「她開始**懷疑 / 質疑**自己是否作出了正確決定。」

question something = 對某項說法、決定、做法或事實是否正確、合理或可靠表示懷疑

Compare:

> “The police **questioned** him.”

= 警方**盤問**他。

versus:

> “The police **questioned** his story.”

= 警方**質疑**他的說法。

Same verb, different mental concept.

Fixed expression: **call something into question** — 對.....提出質疑

Practice 14

> “The new evidence **calls** his explanation into question.”

「新證據令他的解釋受到**質疑**。」

Practice 15

> “The errors **called** the reliability of the data into **question**.”

「這些錯誤令人**質疑**數據的可靠性。」

****call something into question = 令某項說法、判斷或可信性變得值得懷疑****

This belongs to the ****doubt**** sense rather than needing another core meaning.

Fixed expression: ****in question — 正在討論的 / 相關的****

Practice 16

> “The document ****in question**** was written several years ago.”

「****所涉及 / 正在談論的那份文件****是在幾年前寫的。」

Practice 17

> “The person ****in question**** has already left the company.”

「****所指的那個人****已經離開公司。」

****in question = 正在被談論、考慮、調查或提及的那個人 / 事物****

Notice that ****in question**** can also mean “in doubt” in another context:

> “His future is in question.”

= 他的未來仍然****不確定****。

Context decides which interpretation applies.

Fixed expression: ****out of the question — 不可能；絕對不行****

Practice 18

> “Buying a new car is ****out of the question**** at the moment.”

「目前買新車是****完全不可能 / 根本不考慮的****。」

Practice 19

> “Leaving the children alone is ****out of the question****.”

「把孩子單獨留下是****絕對不可以的****。」

****out of the question = 完全不可能、不允許或不能考慮****

This is idiomatic and should remain a fixed-expression extension.

Fixed expression: ****no question / without question — 毫無疑問****

Practice 20

> “There is ****no question**** that she worked hard.”

「毫無****疑問****，她非常努力。」

Practice 21

> “He is, ****without question****, one of the most experienced people on the team.”

「他****毫無疑問****是團隊中最有經驗的人之一。」

****no question / without question = 沒有任何合理懷疑；毫無疑問****

This develops directly from the ****doubt/uncertainty**** sense.

Fixed expression: ****pop the question — 求婚****

A common informal idiom:

Practice 22

> “He finally ****popped the question**** during their trip.”

「他終於在旅途中向她****求婚****。」

Practice 23

> “She knew he was planning to ****pop the question****.”

「她知道他正打算****求婚****。」

****pop the question = 向某人提出結婚要求；非正式****

The “question” is understood to be:

> “Will you marry me?”

This is a useful idiom, not another core lexical meaning of **question**.

Related form: **questioning**

Questioning can describe:

questioning = asking questions (提問 / 盤問)

> “The police continued their **questioning**.”

「警方繼續進行**盤問**。」

questioning = showing doubt (帶有疑問 / 質疑的)

> “She gave him a **questioning look**.”

「她帶着**疑惑 / 詢問意味的眼神**看着他。」

questioning = 正在詢問；或顯示懷疑、疑惑、想知道答案的

Related form: **questionable**

Questionable means something is doubtful in quality, truth, legality, morality, or acceptability.

Practice 24

> “The report is based on **questionable evidence**.”

「這份報告建基於**可靠性成疑的證據**。」

Practice 25

> “That was a **questionable decision**.”

「那是一個**是否合理值得質疑的決定**。」

questionable = 真實性、正確性、品質、道德或合理性值得懷疑的

Related form: **unquestionable**

Unquestionable means so clear, certain, or established that reasonable doubt is not appropriate.

Practice 26

> “Her talent is **unquestionable**.”

「她的才華是**無可置疑的**。」

Practice 27

> “The evidence shows his **unquestionable** influence on the field.”

「證據顯示他對這個領域具有**無可置疑的影響力**。」

unquestionable = 十分明確、確定或可靠，幾乎沒有合理懷疑空間的

Related form: **unquestionably**

Practice 28

> “She is **unquestionably** talented.”

「她**毫無疑問**很有才華。」

Practice 29

> “The project was **unquestionably** successful.”

「這個項目**毫無疑問**是成功的。」

unquestionably = 以沒有合理疑問或爭議的程度；毫無疑問地

Related form: **questionnaire**

A **questionnaire** is a set of written questions used to collect information from people.

Practice 30

> “Participants completed a short **questionnaire**.”

「參加者填寫了一份簡短的**問卷**。」

Practice 31

> “The **questionnaire** asks about travel habits.”

「這份**問卷**詢問旅行習慣。」

questionnaire = 為收集資料而設計、由一系列問題組成的書面或電子問卷

This is a useful lexical family extension, not another meaning of bare **question**.

Important distinction: **question** vs **problem**

These are often both translated as 「問題」, but English distinguishes them.

question

= something you ask or something requiring consideration

> “Can I ask a question?”

problem

= a difficulty that needs solving

> “We have a problem.”

So:

> **answer a question**

but usually:

> **solve a problem**

This distinction is particularly important for Chinese learners because both are commonly 「問題」.

Important distinction: **question** vs **issue**

question

can be an inquiry or a matter requiring consideration.

issue

usually means an important topic, matter, or problem being discussed.

> “the question of cost”

and:

> “the issue of cost”

can overlap, but **question** has much broader grammatical uses.

Important distinction: **question vs doubt**

question

can express or represent doubt.

doubt

more directly means uncertainty or lack of belief.

> “I question whether this is true.”

= 我質疑這是否真實。

> “I doubt that this is true.”

= 我懷疑這不是真的。

They overlap, but the grammatical patterns differ.

Important distinction: **ask vs question**

ask

is the ordinary broad verb for requesting information.

> “She asked me where I lived.”

question

often suggests:

- * repeated/systematic inquiry;
- * formal investigation;
- * or probing carefully.

> “Police questioned him for two hours.”

So **question someone** can sound more intensive or formal than simply **ask someone**.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **question**
- * **questions**
- * **questioned**
- * **questioning**
- * **questionable**
- * **unquestionable**
- * **unquestionably**
- * **questionnaire**

Especially useful expressions include:

- * ask a question
- * the question of...
- * call into question
- * in question
- * out of the question
- * without question
- * pop the question

The Golden Manual requires common fixed expressions and useful family members to be included while keeping them separate from genuinely distinct core meanings.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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question — inquiry	為了取得回答、資訊、解釋或意見而向別人提出的詢問
question — exam/task item	測驗、考試或練習中要求作答的一個題目；屬於「需要回答的詢問」義
question — issue/matter	需要討論、考慮、研究或作出決定的一個事項或議題
question — doubt/uncertainty	對某件事情是否真實、正確、可靠或成立所存在的懷疑或不確定
question someone — verb	向某人提出一連串問題，以取得資料、事實或解釋
question something — verb	對某項說法、決定、事實或做法是否正確、合理或可靠表示懷疑
questionable	真實性、正確性、品質、道德或合理性值得懷疑的
unquestionable	十分明確或可靠，沒有合理懷疑空間的
questionnaire	為收集資料而由一系列問題組成的書面或電子問卷

For your original sentence

> “More importantly, he asks sharp ****questions****.”

The exact meaning is:

****question = 為了取得回答、了解對方想法或引導對方思考而提出的詢問****

More specifically:

****sharp question = 能準確指出重點、令人深入思考的問題****

So:

> ****he asks sharp questions****

= ****他很會提出尖銳、有洞察力而且能令人思考的問題****

For your database, I would count ****5 genuinely distinct core polysemy/polyfunctionality meanings**** for ****question****:

1. ****noun — something asked in order to receive an answer****
2. ****noun — an issue/matter requiring consideration****
3. ****noun — doubt or uncertainty****
4. ****verb — ask/interrogate someone for information****
5. ****verb — doubt/challenge the truth, correctness, or validity of something****

I would merge ****exam question**** into #1, and treat ****call into question, in question, out of the question, without question,**** and ****pop the question**** as important fixed expressions rather than inflate the core count.